

Dongkeun Choi

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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of California San Diego	2027 (expected)
M.A. in Economics, Korea University, South Korea	2021
B.A. in Economics and B.S. in Financial Engineering, Korea University, South Korea	2019

Research Interests

Macroeconomics, Monetary Economics, Financial Intermediation

References

James D. Hamilton (*Chair*)
Professor
Department of Economics
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Juan Herreño
Assistant Professor
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Associate Professor
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Job Market Paper

Unintended Risks of Bank Capital Regulations

Abstract. Nonbank financial intermediaries (NBFIs) have reemerged as major U.S. credit suppliers. Using loan-level mortgage data, I document that NBFI-originated loans exhibit looser underwriting standards and higher default rates than bank loans. In addition, tighter capital requirements are associated with both NBFI expansion and a shift toward borrowers with riskier profiles. I develop a general equilibrium model in which banks and NBFIs choose loan rates and underwriting standards. Banks fund their lending with deposits subject to capital requirements, while NBFIs rely on market-based funding outside the regulatory perimeter. Tighter capital requirements shift origination toward NBFIs, raising defaults through changes in the composition of underlying risks. Introducing underwriting regulations governing NBFI lending reduces credit losses more effectively than tightening bank capital requirements.

Working Papers

Equipment, Structures, and the Limits of Investment-Specific Technological Change (with Munseob Lee)

Work in Progress

Why Is Monetary Policy Less Effective at Low Interest Rates: The Role of Banking Sector

Redistribution through the Secondary Mortgage Market

Research Experience

Dissertation Fellow, Federal Reserve Board	Summer 2026
Research Assistant, Prof. Munseob Lee, UC San Diego	2022–2023
Research Assistant, Prof. Jinill Kim, Korea University	2020–2021

Presentations

2026 Federal Reserve Board, Midwest Macro Meeting (Milwaukee), FIRS (Miami), UCSD

Teaching Experience

UC San Diego

Long Run Macroeconomics (UG), Teaching Assistant	2022
Short Run Macroeconomics (UG), Teaching Assistant	2023–2026
International Finance (UG), Teaching Assistant	2023–2024
Macroeconomics B (G), Teaching Assistant	2023
Macroeconomics C (G), Teaching Assistant	2023

Korea University

Intermediate Macroeconomics (UG), Teaching Assistant	2020–2021
Macroeconomics I & II (G), Teaching Assistant	2020–2021

Fellowships, Grants, and Awards

FIRS PhD Student Travel Grant	2026
Travel and Research Grant, UC San Diego	2026
Clive Granger Research Fellowship, UC San Diego	2025
Research Fellowships, Prof. James D. Hamilton, UC San Diego	2024, 2025
Summer Research Fellowships, UC San Diego	2022, 2023
Regent Fellowship, UC San Diego	2021–2022
Research Grant, Korea Foundation of Abroad Studies (KFAS)	2021–2026
Brain Korea 21+ Graduate Student Scholarship, Korea University	2019–2020
President's List, Korea University	Spring 2017

Additional Information

Programming	Matlab, Dynare, Stata, Python
Languages	English (fluent), Korean (native)
Citizenship	South Korea (F-1 Visa)